d. Industrial Development Post 1991 Reforms

The year 1991 ushered a new era of the economic liberalisation. India took major decision to improve the performance of the industrial sector. The Tenth and Eleventh Five-Year Plans witnessed a high growth rate of industrial production. The abolition of industrial licensing, dismantling of price controls, dilution of reservation of small-scale industries and virtual abolition of monopoly law enabled Indian industry to flourish. The new policy welcomes foreign investments.

Modernisation

India has now a large variety of industries producing goods of varied nature, which shows a high degree of modernisation. Some modern industries have really grown and they are competing effectively with the outside world. This has reduced our dependence greatly on foreign experts and technologists. On the contrary, India is exporting trained personnel to relatively less developed countries.

The term information technology includes computer and communication technology along with software. Along with three-sector model of primary, secondary and tertiary industries, a fourth sector, information-related industries, has emerged. The knowledge economy depicts the automation of labour-intensive manufacturing and service activities as well as growth in new service industries such as health care, distance education, software production and multimedia entertainment.

Self-Reliance

Another positive aspect of industrial growth is the attainment of the goal of self-reliance. We have achieved self-reliance in machinery, plant and other equipment. Today, the bulk of the equipment required for industrial and infrastructural development is produced within the country.

The Indian road network has become one of the largest in the world. Government efforts led to the expansion of the network of National Highways, State highways and major district roads, which in turn has directly contributed to industrial growth.

As India needs power to drive its growth engine, it has triggered a noteworthy improvement of availability of energy. After almost seven decades of independence, India has emerged as the third largest producer of electricity in Asia.

Conclusion

Industrialisation is an important component of economic growth. India's industrial expansion over the plan period presents a mixed picture. Compared to the pre-independence level, industrial growth during the Five-Year plan periods is phenomenal.

Recap

- The history of Indian Industry dates back to the history of human kind.
- The crafts in India has a rich history.
- Indian handicrafts that had made the country famous, collapsed under the Colonical rule.

GLOSSARY

incredible	unbelievable	நம்பமுடியாத
indigenous	native	உள்நாட்டு
acceleration	increasing the speed	விரைவுப்படுத்துதல்
swadeshi	produced with in this country	உள்நாட்டு உற்பத்திப்பொருள்
entrepreneur	businessman	தொழில் முனைவோர்
retrogression	to return to older	பின்னோக்கிச் செல்லுதல்

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